ROALLA



EXECUTIVE GROWTH LEADERSHIP DECISION GUIDE

Executive Hiring Readiness and the First 100 Days

Define the mandate select for evidence and make the organization ready for executive success

Prepared for founders, owners, boards, chief executives, investors and functional leaders in growth companies

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Purpose

This guide helps owners and boards decide whether they are ready to hire an executive, build a mandate-led selection process and design the first 100 days. It addresses authority, outcomes, stakeholder alignment, evidence-based assessment, onboarding and the organizational changes required for the hire to succeed.

EXECUTIVE DECISION DASHBOARD

Management View at a Glance

An executive hire cannot fix an undefined mandate or an organization unwilling to transfer authority. Readiness begins before search. The first 100 days should establish evidence, relationships, decisions and operating mechanisms—not reward theatrical certainty.

Executive question	ROALLA view	Decision implication
Should search begin before the mandate is final?	**NO**	A vague brief attracts impressive but mismatched candidates.
Is industry experience the primary criterion?	**CONDITIONAL**	Relevant patterns help, but stage, mandate and leadership evidence matter more.
Should the new executive deliver a strategy immediately?	**NO**	Early certainty without a fact base can create costly mistakes.
Can the incumbent organization remain unchanged?	**NO**	Authority, interfaces and reporting often need to change.
What should management authorize now?	**PURSUE**	A hiring-readiness gate before engaging the market.

Recommended Management Posture

Use the decision model to convert management confidence into verified evidence, explicit ownership and sequenced action. A weighted score supports prioritization, but a material hard-gate failure should override an attractive average.

Questions to Put to the Leadership Team

1. What enterprise outcome makes this an executive role?
2. What decisions will actually transfer?
3. Could fractional or interim leadership meet the need?
4. Which candidate evidence predicts success at this stage?
5. How will structured assessment reduce bias?
6. What must the organization change before arrival?
7. What should be true after 30, 60 and 100 days?
8. How will mandate or fit concerns be surfaced early?

EXECUTIVE DECISION MODEL

The Eight Executive Hiring Gates

These gates distinguish a needed executive accountability from an attractive title. Use them to test mandate, authority, capacity, interfaces and evolution before recruiting or reorganizing.

Stage	Gate	Required conclusion	Decision evidence
01	Need	The executive accountability is evidenced	Outcomes, decisions, capacity and opportunity cost
02	Mandate	Success and authority are explicit	Scope, exclusions, measures and decision rights
03	Readiness	The organization will enable the role	CEO sponsorship, information, budget and leadership alignment
04	Profile	Selection criteria follow the mandate	Experiences, capabilities, behaviours and stage fit
05	Evidence	Candidates are assessed consistently	Work samples, structured interviews, references and trade-offs
06	Contract	Terms support outcomes and retention	Compensation, incentives, obligations and exit
07	Onboarding	The first 100 days are designed	Context, relationships, diagnostics, decisions and early outcomes
08	Review	Performance and fit are evaluated fairly	Milestones, feedback, evidence and course correction

Decision Rule

A failed hard gate moves the initiative to Prepare or Monitor. A strong narrative, senior sponsor or attractive market cannot replace missing authority, evidence, delivery capacity or operating control.

SECTION 01

Readiness Framework

Translate ambition into a shared executive view of value, evidence, capability and risk.



MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT MODEL

Readiness Dimensions

No.	Decision area	Management evidence	Status
01	Business need	Outcomes, gaps, timing and alternative models	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
02	Role mandate	Scope, authority, interfaces and measures	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
03	Organization readiness	Sponsorship, information, budget and acceptance	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
04	Selection evidence	Criteria, assessment, references and bias control	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
05	First 100 days	Learning, relationships, decisions and early value	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**
06	Performance governance	Feedback, milestones, incentives and correction	**Confirmed / Developing / Gap**

Evidence Standard

Assessments should distinguish verified evidence from management confidence. Where evidence is incomplete, record the gap, owner, completion date and decision that depends on it.

STRATEGIC READINESS DEPENDENCIES

What Readiness Depends On

Dependency	Why it matters	Evidence management should expect
Need	The executive accountability is evidenced	Outcomes, decisions, capacity and opportunity cost
Mandate	Success and authority are explicit	Scope, exclusions, measures and decision rights
Readiness	The organization will enable the role	CEO sponsorship, information, budget and leadership alignment
Profile	Selection criteria follow the mandate	Experiences, capabilities, behaviours and stage fit
Evidence	Candidates are assessed consistently	Work samples, structured interviews, references and trade-offs
Contract	Terms support outcomes and retention	Compensation, incentives, obligations and exit
Onboarding	The first 100 days are designed	Context, relationships, diagnostics, decisions and early outcomes
Review	Performance and fit are evaluated fairly	Milestones, feedback, evidence and course correction

ROALLA Interpretation

Dependencies should be evaluated as a connected system. A weakness in ownership, data, architecture, delivery or governance can change the economics and risk of an otherwise attractive initiative.

SECTION 02

Detailed Readiness Assessment

Convert executive intent into verifiable requirements, accountable evidence and clear remediation actions.



READINESS CHECKLIST

Hiring Readiness and Selection

Completion standard Mark Ready only when the supporting evidence has been verified. Assign an evidence owner to every open item.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
A01	The company has tested whether the need is executive, functional or advisory.	☐	☐	_____
A02	The mandate states outcomes, authority and explicit non-accountabilities.	☐	☐	_____
A03	The CEO and board agree on what success looks like after 12 and 24 months.	☐	☐	_____
A04	Reporting lines and peer interfaces support the mandate.	☐	☐	_____
A05	The organization is prepared to transfer decisions and budget.	☐	☐	_____
A06	Selection criteria distinguish required capabilities from preferences.	☐	☐	_____
A07	Structured interviews use common questions and evidence standards.	☐	☐	_____
A08	Candidates complete realistic work or decision exercises.	☐	☐	_____
A09	References test specific leadership claims and stage fit.	☐	☐	_____
A10	Compensation and incentives align with balanced enterprise outcomes.	☐	☐	_____

READINESS CHECKLIST CONTINUED

First 100 Days and Performance Readiness

Completion standard Use Gap to create a dated remediation action and identify the management decision that cannot proceed.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
B01	A sponsor owns the executive's organizational onboarding.	☐	☐	_____
B02	The new leader receives customer, financial, people, risk and operating context.	☐	☐	_____
B03	Stakeholder meetings have clear learning and relationship objectives.	☐	☐	_____
B04	The first 30 days emphasize evidence before irreversible change.	☐	☐	_____
B05	Days 31 to 60 produce a shared fact base and priority decisions.	☐	☐	_____
B06	Days 61 to 100 mobilize the agreed operating and capability changes.	☐	☐	_____
B07	Early wins reinforce the mandate without distracting from structural work.	☐	☐	_____
B08	The executive and CEO review decision rights and interface friction frequently.	☐	☐	_____
B09	Performance milestones measure outcomes, team health and enterprise contribution.	☐	☐	_____
B10	A formal 100-day review confirms, adjusts or resets the mandate.	☐	☐	_____

WEIGHTED EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Readiness Scorecard

Dimension	Weight	Evidence standard	Score	Status
Business need	20%	Outcomes, gaps, timing and alternative models	__/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Role mandate	20%	Scope, authority, interfaces and measures	__/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Organization readiness	15%	Sponsorship, information, budget and acceptance	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Selection evidence	15%	Criteria, assessment, references and bias control	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
First 100 days	15%	Learning, relationships, decisions and early value	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Performance governance	15%	Feedback, milestones, incentives and correction	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
TOTAL	100%	Weighted executive assessment	__/100	Pursue / Prepare / Monitor

Decision Thresholds

Score	Posture	Management decision
75 to 100	**PURSUE**	Proceed to bounded execution subject to no hard-gate failure.
50 to 74	**PREPARE**	Complete a focused readiness plan before major commitment.
0 to 49	**MONITOR**	Resolve foundational gaps before investing further.

A single material hard-gate failure overrides the weighted score. ROALLA also applies judgment where administrative readiness is high but strategic value, adoption or commercial viability is weak.

SECTION 03

Execution and Advisory Roadmap

Build evidence and decision clarity before changing titles or recruiting. Use the first 90 days to prove the executive hire and first 100 day plan in the company's real operating context.



READINESS OPERATING PLAN

Recommended 90 Day Mobilization

Timing	Focus	Key activities	Management output
Days 1 to 15	Clarify	Confirm growth objectives, current executive hire and first 100 day plan, decision pressure and executive sponsor.	Approved diagnostic mandate
Days 16 to 35	Assess	Interview leaders, review evidence, map accountabilities and identify hard gaps.	Current-state evidence map
Days 36 to 55	Design	Develop practical options with mandate, interfaces, capacity, economics and risk.	Decision-ready options
Days 56 to 75	Validate	Test the preferred model through real decisions, management forums and team feedback.	Validated leadership model
Days 76 to 90	Mobilize	Approve owners, measures, communication, transition actions and review dates.	90-day activation plan

Twelve to Twenty Four Month Path

- Quarter 1: clarify the executive hire and first 100 day plan, decision rights, interfaces and immediate capacity gaps.
- Quarter 2: embed management cadence, measures, delegation and leadership-team working practices.
- Quarters 3 and 4: adjust spans, roles and succession as scale and complexity increase.
- Year 2: review executive architecture against strategy, performance, risk and the next growth stage.

ROALLA ADVISORY MODEL

How ROALLA Can Help

ROALLA brings an independent transformation and technology perspective to executive hiring readiness and onboarding. The objective is a leadership system that converts strategy into accountable decisions, scalable execution and measurable enterprise value.

ROALLA workstream	Executive value
Executive diagnostic	Assess strategy, growth stage, operating complexity, leadership load and material gaps.
Mandate design	Define outcomes, scope, authority, decision rights and explicit non-accountabilities.
Operating model	Align functions, forums, information flows, escalation paths and management cadence.
Technology and product alignment	Connect architecture, delivery, product, commercial and operational leadership.
Role and capacity options	Compare combined, fractional, interim and full-time structures using evidence.
Scorecards and incentives	Translate enterprise priorities into balanced executive outcomes and measures.
Selection and onboarding	Build role briefs, evaluation criteria, interview evidence and first-100-day plans.
Evolution assurance	Monitor effectiveness, challenge gaps and reset roles as strategy and scale change.

Recommended Initial Mandate

- Four-week executive structure and accountability diagnostic.
- Decision-rights map and leadership capacity assessment.
- Recommended executive hire and first 100 day plan with role mandates, interfaces and transition risks.
- Executive readout and 90-day activation roadmap.

CONTROL FRAMEWORK

Key Risks and Controls

Risk	Exposure	ROALLA control
Undefined mandate	Selection optimizes for charisma or résumé.	Complete role design first.
Authority mismatch	The executive owns outcomes but cannot decide.	Transfer explicit authority and resources.
Clone bias	The search favours familiar profiles.	Use evidence-based criteria and panels.
Stage mismatch	Large-company success does not transfer.	Assess operating context and adaptability.
Premature action	The hire reorganizes before learning.	Sequence evidence, decisions and change.
Founder override	Authority disappears when choices become difficult.	Govern reserved matters and escalation.
Onboarding neglect	The executive spends months finding context.	Provide structured access and sponsorship.
Delayed feedback	Misalignment grows until failure.	Use frequent milestone reviews.

Professional Advice

Qualified legal, privacy, security, tax, accounting, employment and regulatory advisors should validate matters within their professional scope. ROALLA coordinates those inputs with technology strategy, architecture, commercialization, governance and transformation decisions.

OFFICIAL EVIDENCE BASE

Selected Official Sources

These sources support the management principles summarized in this guide. Standards, laws, guidance and organizational obligations continue to evolve and must be confirmed for the specific context before acting.

McKinsey Redefining the Role of the Technology Officer. Official source — Executive perspective on the technology leader as business strategist, transformation leader and builder of organizational capability.

McKinsey Why You Need a CTO and How to Make the Role Successful. Official source — Guidance on the CTO mandate, organizational interfaces, authority and conditions required for success.

Microsoft Cloud Adoption Framework RACI Alignment. Official source — Examples for assigning accountable, responsible, consulted and informed roles across strategy, governance, platforms and operations.

Advisory Disclaimer

This ROALLA guide is a strategic readiness and marketing document. It is not a certification, audit opinion, legal opinion, privacy opinion, security assurance, investment recommendation or guarantee of results. Management must validate current obligations, company facts and professional advice before making material decisions.